

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior SOC Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel | Incident Response | Detection Engineering | MITRE ATT&CK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Operations Centre (SOC) Analyst with over five years of experience specialising in detection and response across Microsoft 365 environments. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring deep hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender security tooling. I actively investigate incidents, handle alert queues, develop and tune detection capabilities, and write Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules. I build and improve Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to accelerate response effectiveness, and I apply the MITRE ATT&CK framework systematically to detection engineering and threat hunting. I am equally at home strengthening processes and tooling as I am on the front line of incident investigation, and I communicate findings clearly to both technical and non-technical audiences.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel - KQL analytics rules, detection tuning, threat correlation, log source integration, workbooks and reporting
- **Microsoft 365 Security Tooling:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Office 365
- **SOAR and Automated Response:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic App playbooks, SOAR workflow automation, automated alert triage and containment
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL-based detection rule development, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage mapping, alert fidelity improvement, false positive reduction
- **Incident Response:** Active incident investigation, alert handling, containment and eradication, NIST 800-61 methodology, post-incident reviews and lessons learned
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hypothesis-driven threat hunting across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry using MITRE ATT&CK
- **Endpoint and Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, endpoint detection and response
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover, CrowdStrike NG-SIEM) - Expert
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Scripting:** PowerShell for security automation and investigation support
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Actively investigate security incidents and handle alert queues across Microsoft 365 environment, using Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender to detect, contain, and eradicate threats
- Lead detection engineering function, developing and tuning KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert triage, enrichment, and containment workflows, accelerating mean time to respond (MTTR) for common incident types
- Conduct proactive threat hunting across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud telemetry using hypothesis-driven methodologies grounded in the MITRE ATT&CK framework and current threat intelligence

- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across eight thousand-plus endpoints, leveraging Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover, and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM for endpoint detection, investigation, and response
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO configurations, monitoring for identity-based anomalies and responding to identity threats
- Lead incident management including coordination, stakeholder communication, containment decisions, and post-incident review processes in line with NIST 800-61
- Conduct vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, Pentera BAS, AppCheck, and Nessus, integrating vulnerability findings into risk-based prioritisation and coordinating remediation
- Produce regular security operations reporting and detection health metrics for senior stakeholders, communicating risk and response effectiveness clearly to non-technical audiences

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Onboarded and operationalised Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR from initial deployment through to production, writing KQL analytics rules and building automated Logic App playbooks aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques
- Managed day-to-day alert handling and incident investigation across Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), improving detection fidelity through continuous tuning
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across eight thousand-plus endpoints, establishing enterprise endpoint detection and response capability and integrating CrowdStrike signals into the broader SIEM detection ecosystem
- Developed detection logic for identity-based attack patterns using Microsoft Sentinel KQL, including detection of credential stuffing, lateral movement, privilege escalation, and Conditional Access bypass attempts
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, and MFA policies, monitoring for suspicious authentication patterns and responding to identity incidents
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM platform, monitoring privileged access activity and responding to anomalous privileged account behaviour
- Supported and led incident response activities including active investigation, containment coordination, and structured post-incident reviews with documented improvement actions
- Conducted regular vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus, integrating findings into risk-based remediation workflows

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Monitored and investigated security alerts across endpoint, network, and identity security tooling, supporting incident triage and response within a SaaS/FinTech security function
- Implemented and maintained security monitoring controls, endpoint security, and Identity and Access Management (IAM) policies across the cloud and on-premises infrastructure
- Supported incident handling processes including investigation documentation, lessons-learned outputs, and improvement action tracking
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and coordinated remediation of identified findings, contributing to security controls documentation and ISO 27001 audit readiness

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Engineered and onboarded Microsoft Sentinel SIEM/SOAR at UAL from initial setup through to production, delivering a library of custom KQL analytics rules and SOAR playbooks aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, significantly reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR)
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across eight thousand users, establishing unified XDR detection and response coverage across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud workloads within Microsoft 365 Defender

- Built automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate containment of common incident types including compromised accounts, malware detections, and phishing responses, reducing analyst handling time per incident
- Led detection engineering programme, mapping KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, achieving measurable improvement in detection coverage against common threat actor techniques
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across eight thousand-plus endpoints, providing comprehensive endpoint visibility and integrating CrowdStrike threat intelligence into the SIEM detection ecosystem
- Conducted proactive threat hunting campaigns using MITRE ATT&CK-hypothesis-driven methodology, identifying previously undetected threats and informing improvements to detection rules and response playbooks

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-85,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)